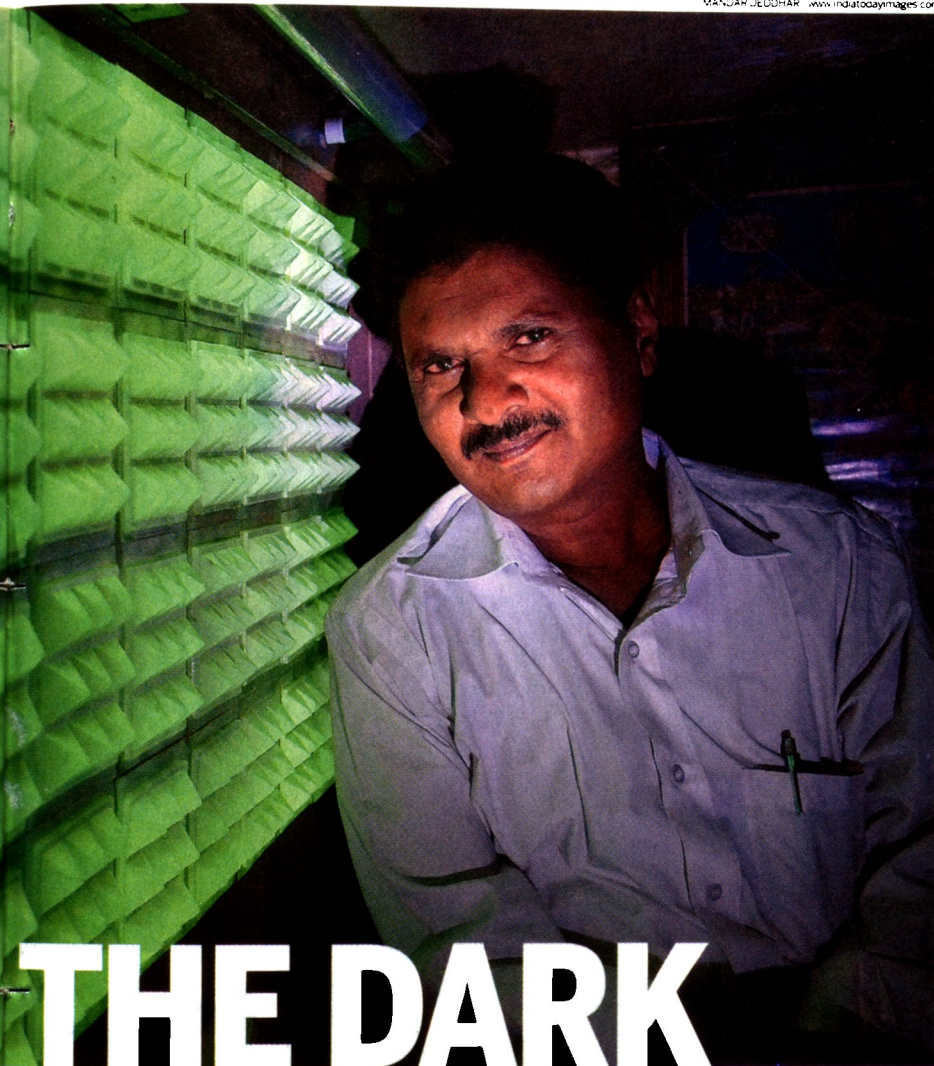




THE TILE EMITS GREEN LIGHT ON ITS OWN FOR EIGHT HOURS AFTER ABSORBING ARTIFICIAL LIGHT FOR THREE HOURS.

SAWANT WITH HIS TILES

The chance comment spiralled into a fully fledged interior decoration business, allowing him to quit the packaging trade. He got the powder from a local supplier in Hyderabad and modified the paint. "From luxury decoration, I switched to disaster management. Instead of using this paint for a limited purpose, I thought why not try to develop it as an alternative source of light that will not require electricity consumption," he adds.

His light emitting paint is already being used in the Thane Municipal Corporation, Raj Bhavan and Trident Hotel in Bandra Kurla. But this was still not enough and he embarked on a journey to design the tile. His recent claim to fame is a vacuum pump design that features in one of the final scenes of the movie *3 Idiots* where it was used to deliver a baby. The proud innovator says that the film crew approached him after they had read about him in a newspaper. While the Aamir Khan-starrer minted big money in the box office, Sawant waits for funding to come through so that he can start manufacturing his tile. After this darkness will come a new light, Sawant is sure.

THE DARK

completing a mechanical engineering diploma in Mumbai and working as a maintenance and service engineer, he decided to set up his own business, Indra Technologies. He started manufacturing pouch packaging in a 250-sq ft space in a slum with 12 workers. "I made 40 to 60 machines myself and they could produce 3,000 pouches per hour," he says proudly. Despite the daily pressures of handling a business, Sawant was always thinking of new solutions. He developed shockproof

packaging, which was injected with a special chemical to develop air pressure. One day, one of his employees told Sawant that he had seen glowing stars in someone's home. Fascinated by the concept, Sawant's brain instantly started ticking. It reminded him of a glow pigment he had sourced from Canada for one of his homemade innovations. "I knew this pigment was available and that it could be turned into a profitable proposition," he says. He was right.

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